

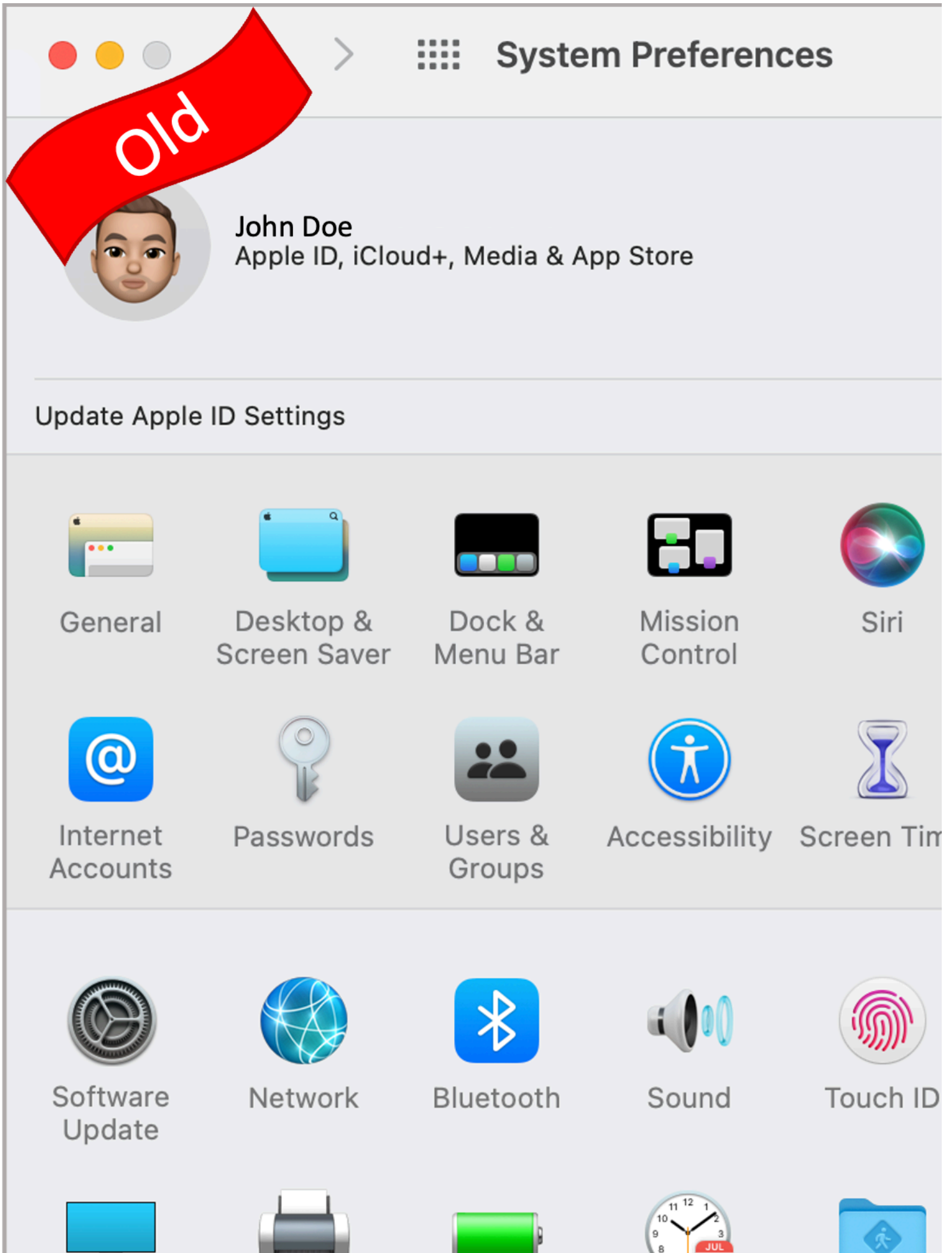
Reading: Updates for macOS

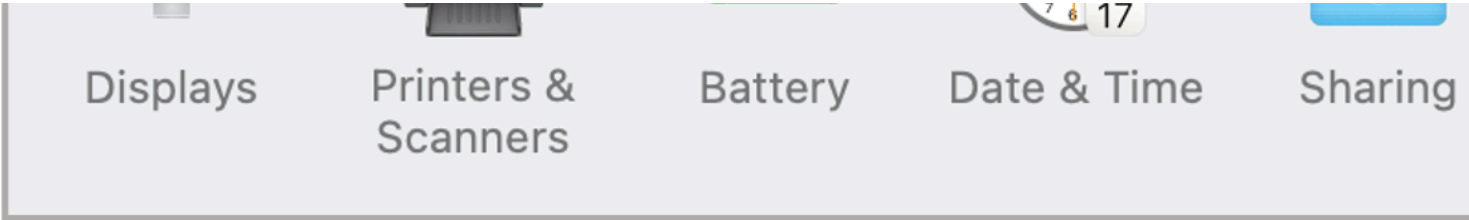
Estimated duration: 2 minutes

macOS recently moved from System Preferences to System Settings. Companies often make such changes to improve consistency, clarity, or alignment with naming conventions used in their other products or services. Apple likely made this change as part of a broader user interface or naming update.

Apple made significant changes to the familiar System Preferences app. First, the app itself has been renamed and is now called System Settings. This change aligns with Apple's effort to standardize nomenclature across its software ecosystem.

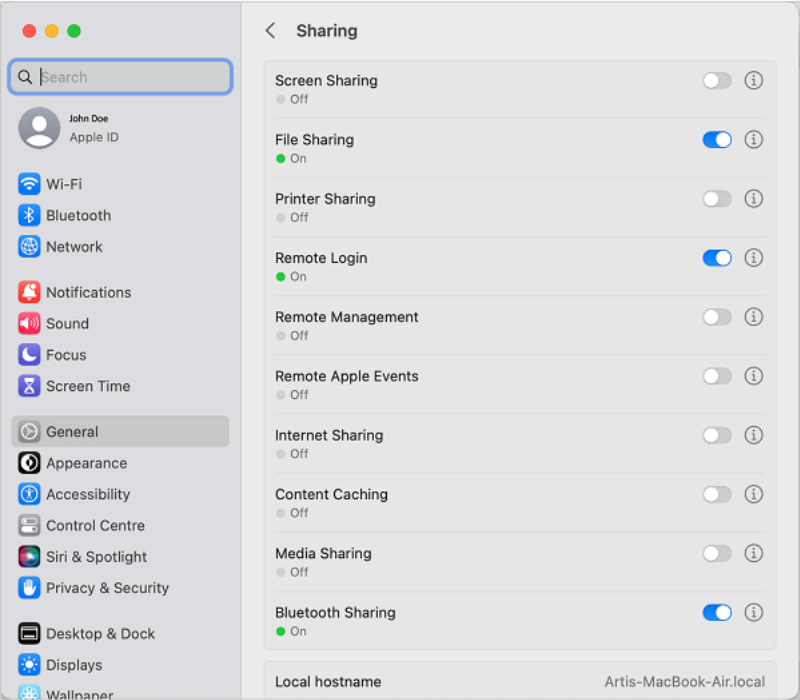
The transition from the icon-based view to a more streamlined list format in the left column also marks a significant change.





In the previous System Preferences app, selecting an icon opened a dedicated settings window. The new System Settings takes a different approach. When you click on a specific setting in the list, the customization options display in the main panel, as seen in the graphic above. In addition, some settings have been rearranged for a more logical and user-friendly UI.

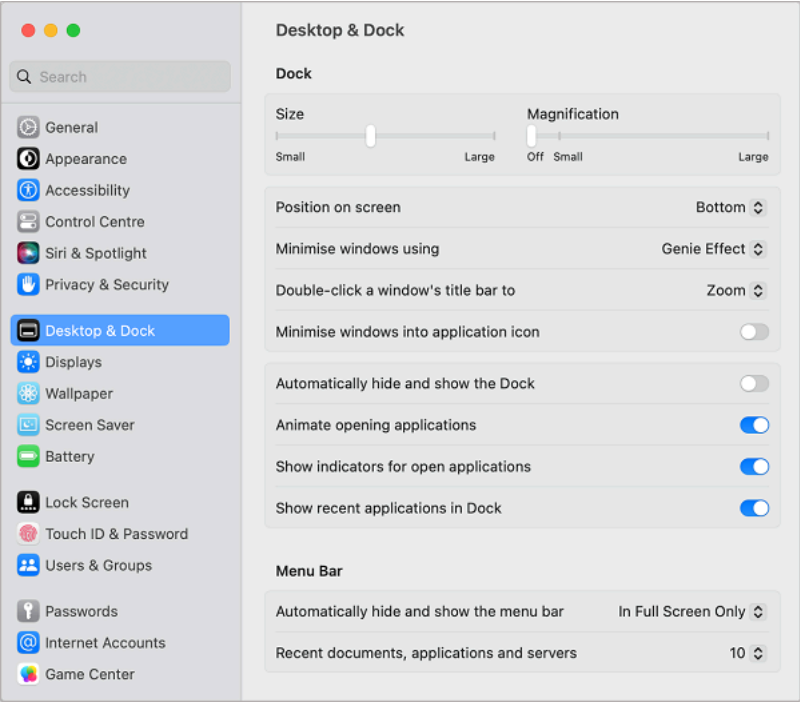
In line with the move towards a more coherent visual language across Apple platforms, toggle switches replace the checkboxes used to fill the various settings.



This change in design aesthetic brings macOS visually closer to its mobile iOS platform. This deliberate similarity perhaps underscores Apple's intention to create a more consistent user experience across all devices.

MacOS redesigned the Spotlight feature as well. Unlike previous macOS versions, where launching a search in the System Preferences triggered a Spotlight-like highlighting of the relevant section, the new System Settings introduces a more direct approach, where the search results immediately display in the sidebar. After selecting a result, the search results remain accessible on the screen, eliminating the need for repeated searches. This search experience streamlining proves to be a convenience-enhancing change.

In an effort to improve the user interface, certain settings that used to reside in the System Preferences app were moved to the Control Center. Also, items like the menu bar, dock settings, and home screen options moved to the Desktop and Dock tab.



Settings like Software Update, Date and Time, and Language and Region can now be found in the General section. Notably, Siri and Spotlight now share a consolidated settings page. Unlike in the past, Login Items previously found in the Users & Groups section are now in the General category.

Apple removed the traditional Software Update shortcut in the About This Mac panel. In addition, the Display, Storage, and Support tabs have been removed from the user interface. Clicking the More Info button takes you to the General > About section, which provides comprehensive information about your Mac system.



The new System Settings in macOS expands the scope of options and introduces several new sections, including Game Controller, Game Center, Lock Screen (previously found under Security & Privacy), Screen Saver (previously found under Desktop & Screen Saver), and Wallpaper (previously part of the Desktop & Screen Saver preferences). These additions expand the customization options available to the user.

In summary, the transition to macOS has resulted in a redesigned System Settings app, accompanied by a number of customizations. Through restructured layouts, visual refinements, and introducing new sections, Apple strives to provide users with a more cohesive, intuitive, and efficient system settings experience.



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